

Ten board questions your AI program should be able to answer

Use this as a first-pass screen for one AI use case. The useful part is not the score. It is the conversation the questions force.

How to use it: pick one initiative, answer with evidence, and mark any answer that depends on confidence, optimism, or a future clean-up project.

Ownership

1. Which executive owns the outcome?

Not the pilot, not the tool, not the vendor relationship. The business result.

2. Which business decision or workflow changes if this AI effort works?

If nothing changes operationally, the program is probably still activity, not transformation.

Risk and governance

3. What could this AI use case get wrong, and who is accountable for catching it?

Name the failure mode, the control, and the person or team responsible.

4. What data, system access, or decision rights does the AI touch?

Boards do not need model details first. They need to know where the AI reaches into the enterprise.

5. What human review remains mandatory?

Separate automation from delegated judgment. If everything is human in the loop, define the loop.

Workforce readiness

6. Who has to change behavior for this to produce value?

AI adoption fails when the model changes faster than the operating routine around it.

7. What training, workflow redesign, or role clarity is required before scale?

Tool access is not readiness. Readiness is the ability to use the tool safely inside real work.

Value proof

8. What measurable business outcome will prove this was worth doing?

Examples: cycle time, risk reduction, cost avoidance, throughput, customer response time, quality, revenue influence.

9. What baseline are we comparing against?

Without a baseline, AI impact becomes a story instead of evidence.

10. What would cause us to stop, redesign, or not scale this use case?

A serious AI program defines kill criteria before momentum makes stopping politically hard.

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If these answers expose a gap between the pilot and the business case, book 45 minutes with Clark.